

RG10

Population, Urbanisation and Tribes of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography is 11-15 questions in every paper and this chapter supplies 2-3 of them. Census indicators by district were asked in 2016, 2018, 2021, 2023 and 2024 - every recent paper. ST population by district was asked in 2013, 2016, 2018 and 2021. Learn the highest-lowest tables cold; that alone covers most of what is asked.

Everything in the first half of this chapter comes from one document - the Census of India 2011. RPSC does not ask you to interpret it. It asks which district is highest, which is lowest, and which tribe lives where. So this is a memorising chapter, and memorising chapters are the cheapest marks in the paper. The tribes half pays twice, because it overlaps with Rajasthan Art and Culture.

Rajasthan Population, Urbanisation & Tribes (Census 2011)

Headline figures

- 6,85,48,437 = 5.66% of India
- 8th in population, 1st in area
- Growth 21.31% (India 17.70%)
- Density 200 (India 382)
- Sex ratio 928 (India 943)
- Literacy 66.11% (India 74.04%)

Highest districts

- Jaipur - population & density
- Kota - literacy & urbanisation
- Dungarpur - sex ratio 994
- Banswara - child sex ratio & ST share
- Barmer - decadal growth 32.5%
- Jhunjhunu - male literacy 86.9%

Lowest districts

- Jaisalmer - density 17, population 6.69 lakh
- Jalore - literacy 54.86%
- Dholpur - sex ratio 846, smallest area
- Jhunjhunu - child sex ratio 837
- Dungarpur - urbanisation 6.4%
- Sri Ganganagar - decadal growth

Urbanisation

- Urban 24.89%, rural 75.11%
- India urban 31.16% - Rajasthan lags
- Million-plus: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota
- 41 districts, 7 divisions (Dec 2024)

SC & ST

- SC 17.83% (1.22 crore)
- ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh)
- ST belt - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur
- SC share highest Sri Ganganagar

Major tribes

- Meena - largest ST, eastern plains
- Bhil - second, southern hills
- Garasia - third, Sirohi-Udaipur-Pali
- Sahariya - only PVTG, Baran

Smaller communities

- Damor - Dungarpur, head 'Mukhi'
- Kathodi - Udaipur, makes katha
- Rabari/Raika - camel herders
- Gadia Lohar, Kanjar, Sansi

Tribal administration

- TAD headquarters - Udaipur
- Tribal Sub-Plan - Fifth Plan, 1974-75
- MADA for scattered pockets
- State Population Policy 2000

First, fix the base year - why 2011 still rules the paper

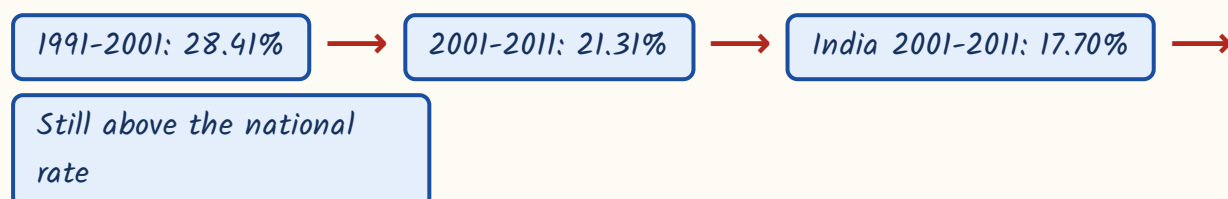
Every population number RPSC asks about Rajasthan comes from the Census of India 2011. The 2021 Census was postponed, so 2011 is still the official base. That is good news for you - the numbers have not moved for fifteen years, and the same figures keep coming back. Whenever you write or recall a population figure, attach the words 'Census 2011' to it in your head. If a question gives you a number without a year, it is a Census 2011 number.

- Census 2011: Rajasthan's population = 6,85,48,437 (about 6.85 crore).
- That is 5.66% of India's population.
- Rank: 8th most populous state of India (Census 2011).
- But Rajasthan is 1st in area - 3,42,239 sq km, 10.41% of India.
- Decadal growth 2001-2011 = 21.31%, against India's 17.70%.
- Rajasthan grew faster than India, but slower than it grew in the previous decade.

TRAP

The single most exploited confusion in this chapter: Rajasthan is **FIRST** in area and **EIGHTH** in population. RPSC frames it as 'which of the following is NOT correct' and slips in 'first in population'. Area first, population eighth. Say it aloud.

Rajasthan's growth rate is decelerating - the trend RPSC likes



CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Government of India has notified the next Census for 2027 - reference date 1 March 2027, with 1 October 2026 for snow-bound areas - and it will include caste enumeration. Until its data is published, every Rajasthan population figure in the paper remains a Census 2011 figure. Expect a general-awareness question on the census schedule itself rather than on new numbers.

The six headline indicators - Rajasthan set against India

Learn these six side by side with the all-India figure. RPSC's favourite trick is a statement question where the Rajasthan number is right but the comparison with India is flipped. Rajasthan is below India on density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy and urbanisation. It is above India only on growth rate. That one asymmetry answers half the statement questions in this chapter.

Census 2011 - Rajasthan vs India, the numbers that get asked

Indicator	Rajasthan 2011	India 2011
Population	6,85,48,437 (5.66% of India)	121.09 crore
Decadal growth 2001-11	21.31% (higher)	17.70%
Density (persons/sq km)	200 (was 165 in 2001)	382
Sex ratio (F per 1000 M)	928	943
Child sex ratio (0-6)	888	919
Literacy - overall	66.11%	74.04%
Literacy - male	79.19%	82.14%
Literacy - female	52.12%	65.46%
Urban share	24.89%	31.16%

Look hard at the literacy line. Male 79.19 and female 52.12 leaves a gender gap of about 27 percentage points - the widest among the major states of India. That gap is itself an examinable fact, not just an arithmetic by-product. And note that Rajasthan's literacy in 2001 was 60.41%, so the decade added roughly six points. Carry the four-number string in your head - 200, 928, 888, 66.11 - density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy, in that order, and notice that the child sex ratio is LOWER than the overall sex ratio.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - Rajasthan's sex ratio as per Census 2011? Answer: 928 females per 1000 males, against the all-India 943. Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - Rajasthan's literacy rate? Answer: 66.11%.

Highest and lowest districts - the matching set RPSC loves most

This is the heart of the chapter. Almost every census question in RAS is a highest-lowest question or a four-pair matching question built from the two tables below. Do not read them once. Write them out from memory until they come without effort. Note the district names are as they stood in Census 2011, before the 2023 reorganisation.

HIGHEST district for each indicator - Census 2011

Indicator	Highest district	Figure
Population	Jaipur	66.26 lakh
Density	Jaipur	595 per sq km
Area	Jaisalmer	38,401 sq km
Decadal growth	Barmer	about 32.5%
Sex ratio	Dungarpur	994
Child sex ratio	Banswara	934

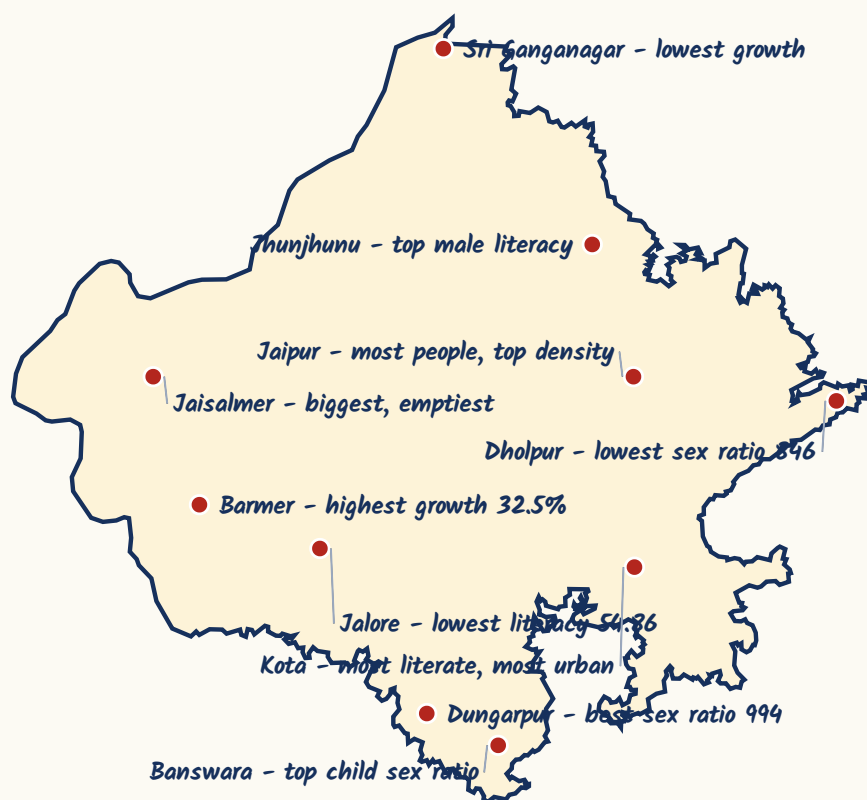
Indicator	Highest district	Figure
Literacy (overall)	Kota	76.56%
Male literacy	Jhunjhunu	about 86.9%
Female literacy	Kota	about 65.9%
Urbanisation	Kota	about 60.3%
ST share of population	Banswara	highest in state
SC share of population	Sri Ganganagar	highest in state

LOWEST district for each indicator – Census 2011

Indicator	Lowest district	Figure
Population	Jaisalmer	6.69 lakh
Density	Jaisalmer	17 per sq km
Area	Dholpur	about 3,034 sq km
Decadal growth	Sri Ganganagar	about 10%
Sex ratio	Dholpur	846
Child sex ratio	Jhunjhunu	837
Literacy (overall)	Jalore	54.86%
Male literacy	Pratapgarh	lowest in state
Female literacy	Jalore	about 38.5%
Urbanisation	Dungarpur	about 6.4%
ST share of population	Nagaur	about 0.2%
SC share of population	Dungarpur	lowest in state

Two ordering facts sit just below the top of these lists, and RPSC has asked them as sequence questions. Sex ratio order at the top: Dungarpur (994), then Rajsamand (990), then Pali (987). Population order at the top: Jaipur (66.26 lakh), Jodhpur (36.87 lakh), Alwar (36.74 lakh), Nagaur (about 33.07 lakh). Jodhpur and Alwar are separated by barely thirteen thousand people, so their order is a favourite trap.

Census 2011 - the highest and the lowest districts



state - the literate, urban south-east at Kota, the empty west at Jaisalmer, the tribal south at Dungarpur and Banswara

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2023 - which district has the highest sex ratio in Rajasthan? Answer: Dungarpur (994). Asked in RAS Pre 2016 as an ordering question - Dungarpur > Rajsamand > Pali, with Dholpur (846) at the bottom. Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - highest literacy district: Kota (76.56%).

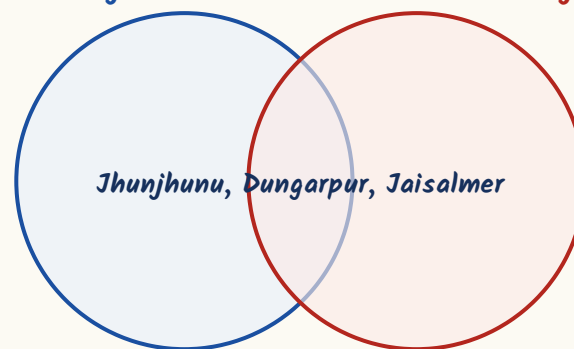
TRAP

Three districts wear two hats and RPSC uses it. Jhunjhunu has the **HIGHEST** male literacy and the **LOWEST** child sex ratio - prosperity did not fix the sex ratio there. Dungarpur has the **HIGHEST** sex ratio and the **LOWEST** urbanisation. Jaisalmer is the **LARGEST** district by area and the **SMALLEST** by population, with the lowest density. Do not assume the lowest density is Barmer - it is Jaisalmer. Barmer's claim is the highest decadal growth.

The districts that top one list and bottom another

Highest in Rajasthan

Lowest in Rajasthan

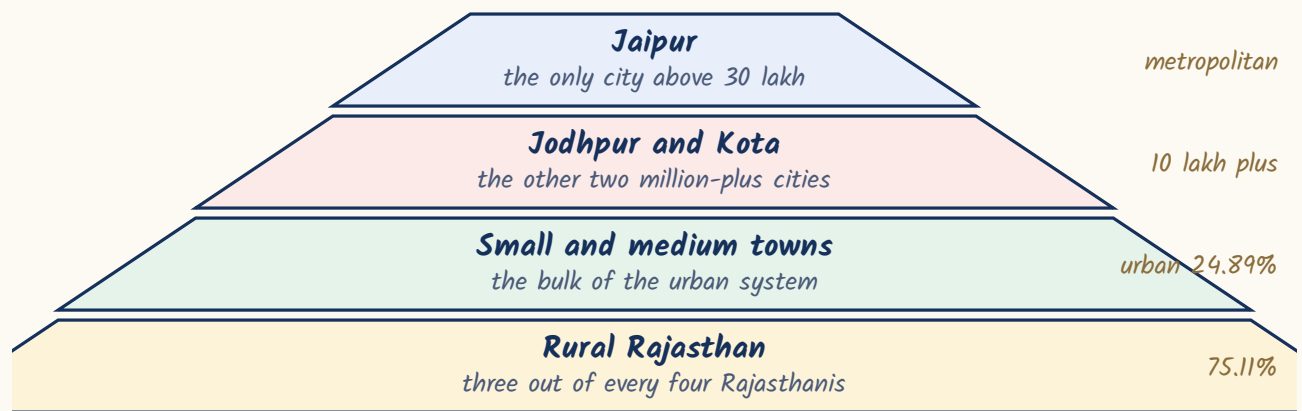


ild sex ratio (837); Dungarpur - highest sex ratio (994) but the lowest urbanisation (6.4%); Jaisalmer -

Rural, urban and the towns of Rajasthan

Rajasthan is a rural state. Three out of four Rajasthanis lived in villages in 2011. The urban share of 24.89% - roughly 1.70 crore people - is well below the national 31.16%. The reason is geography plus economy: a large desert district like Jaisalmer or Barmer has almost no urban base, and the southern tribal districts are the least urbanised of all.

The settlement hierarchy of Rajasthan, Census 2011



- Urban population 24.89% (about 1.70 crore); rural 75.11%.
- India's urban share in 2011 was 31.16% - Rajasthan is below it.
- Most urbanised districts: Kota (about 60.3%), Jaipur (52.4%), Ajmer (40.1%).
- Least urbanised: Dungarpur (about 6.4%), then Banswara and Pratapgarh.
- Million-plus cities in Census 2011 - exactly three: Jaipur, Jodhpur and Kota.
- Jaipur is the only Rajasthan city above 30 lakh; it is the state's only metropolitan-scale city.
- Do not confuse district urbanisation with city size - RPSC mixes them deliberately.
- Only THREE million-plus cities in Census 2011: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.
- Ajmer is NOT a million-plus city, even though Ajmer district is the third most urbanised.
- Class of towns: Rajasthan's urban system is dominated by small and medium towns; Jaipur alone is of metropolitan scale.

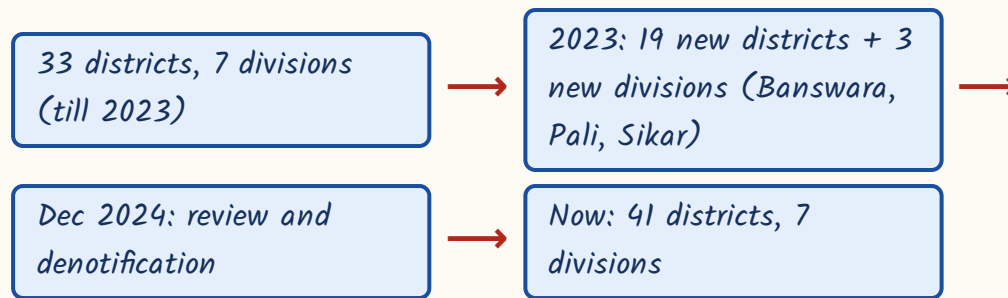
One more contrast worth carrying. Kota is the most urbanised district AND the most literate district. That is not a coincidence - it is the coaching-and-industry town of the state. Dungarpur is the least urbanised AND has the best sex ratio. Urbanisation and sex ratio in Rajasthan run in opposite directions, which is the reverse of the usual textbook assumption.

- Religion, Census 2011: Hindu 88.49%, Muslim 9.07%, Sikh 1.27%, Jain 0.91%, Christian 0.14%.
- Sikhs are concentrated in Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh - the canal-colony districts.
- Work participation rate of Rajasthan in 2011 was ABOVE the all-India average.
- Female work participation is unusually high in the western districts - women do the livestock and field work.
- Rajasthan is a net OUT-migration state; the flow goes to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

The administrative map as it stands now - 41 districts, 7 divisions

This part is not census data at all - it is current affairs, and it changed twice in two years. In 2023 the state created nineteen new districts and three new divisions. In December 2024 the government reviewed that decision and denotified several of them. Learn the position as it stands now, and learn the divisions by name, because divisions are a short and therefore very askable list.

How the district map moved - keep the sequence



- Present position (as of 2026): 41 districts in 7 divisions.
- The seven divisions: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.
- The three divisions created in 2023 - Banswara, Pali and Sikar - were abolished in December 2024.
- Eight of the districts created in 2023 were retained in the December 2024 rationalisation.
- Census 2011 district data still uses the OLD 33-district map - never mix the two.
- Phalodi, Balotra, Didwana-Kuchaman, Deeg and Kotputli-Behror did not exist in 2011.
- If a question says 'as per Census 2011', the answer must be one of the 33 old districts.

Two other administrative facts that ride along with this chapter. Rajasthan announced its State Population Policy in the year 2000 - the year is the whole question. And the Tribal Sub-Plan strategy, which shapes the tribal districts' budgets, began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75.

Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes - shares and where they live

Two numbers, and then the geography. SCs are 17.83% of Rajasthan's population - about 1.22 crore. STs are 13.48% - about 92.38 lakh. The SC population is spread fairly evenly across the state; the ST population is not. Tribal Rajasthan is a compact block in the south and south-east, plus the Meena belt in the eastern plains.

SC and ST - the four distribution facts RPSC matches

Question asked	Answer	Watch out
Highest ST share (%)	Banswara, then Dungarpur	Then Pratapgarh, Udaipur
Highest ST number (absolute)	Udaipur district	NOT Banswara - Udaipur is bigger
Lowest ST share	Nagaur (about 0.2%), then Bikaner	The desert north has almost no ST
Highest SC share (%)	Sri Ganganagar	Canal colony district
Highest SC number (absolute)	Jaipur district	Biggest district overall
Lowest SC share	Dungarpur	Because it is overwhelmingly ST

ASKED IN RAS

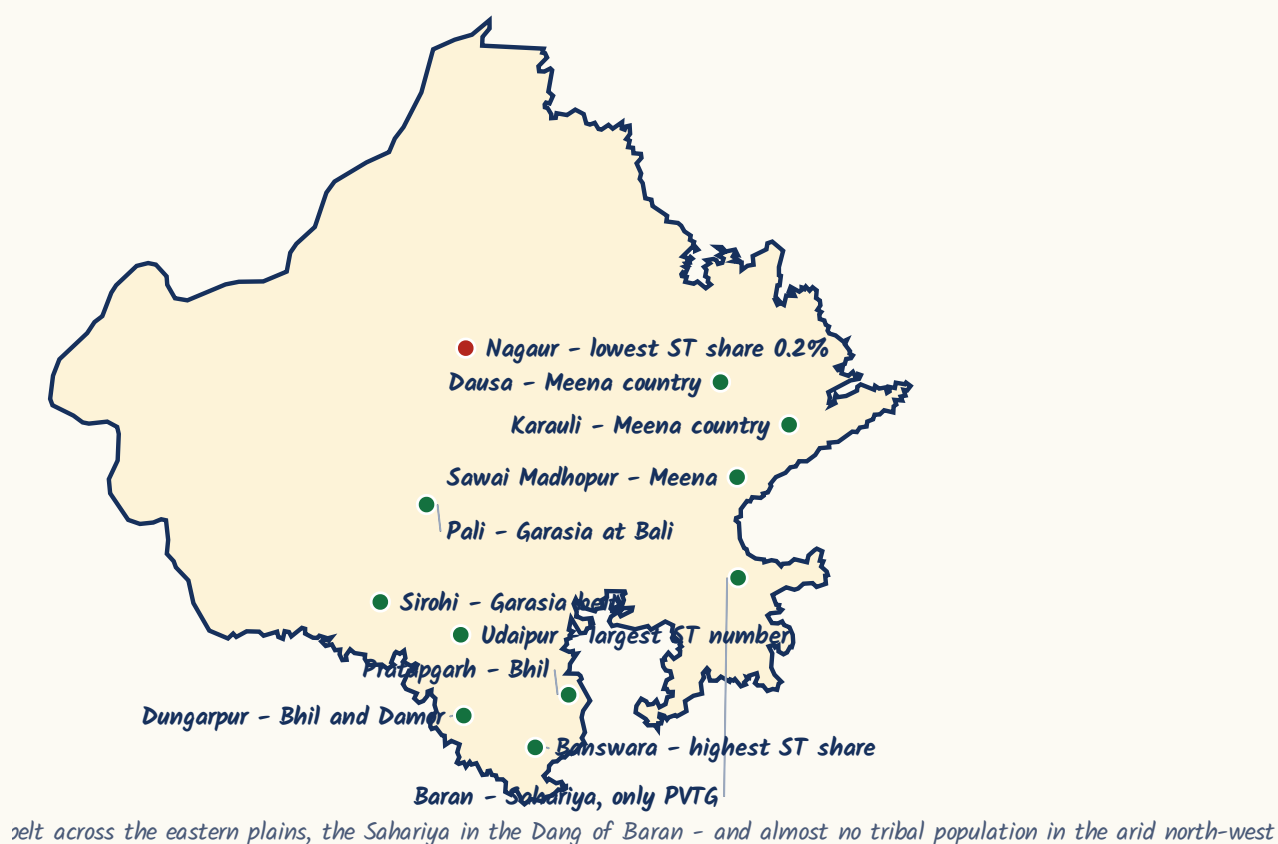
Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the ST share of Rajasthan's population as per Census 2011? Answer: 13.48% (about 92.38 lakh). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and 2021 - the district with the highest proportion of Scheduled Tribes? Answer: Banswara.

TRAP

Share versus number. Banswara has the highest ST PROPORTION; Udaipur has the largest ST POPULATION in absolute terms. Same trap on the SC side: Sri Ganganagar has the highest SC proportion, Jaipur has the largest SC population. Read whether the question says 'percentage' or 'number'.

Why the pattern? The southern districts - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur - are the Bhil hill country, forested and difficult, so the tribal population was never displaced. The eastern plains around Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa and Karauli are Meena country, agricultural and settled. Nagaur and Bikaner in the arid north-west never had a tribal base at all. Understand this map and the district answers stop being arbitrary.

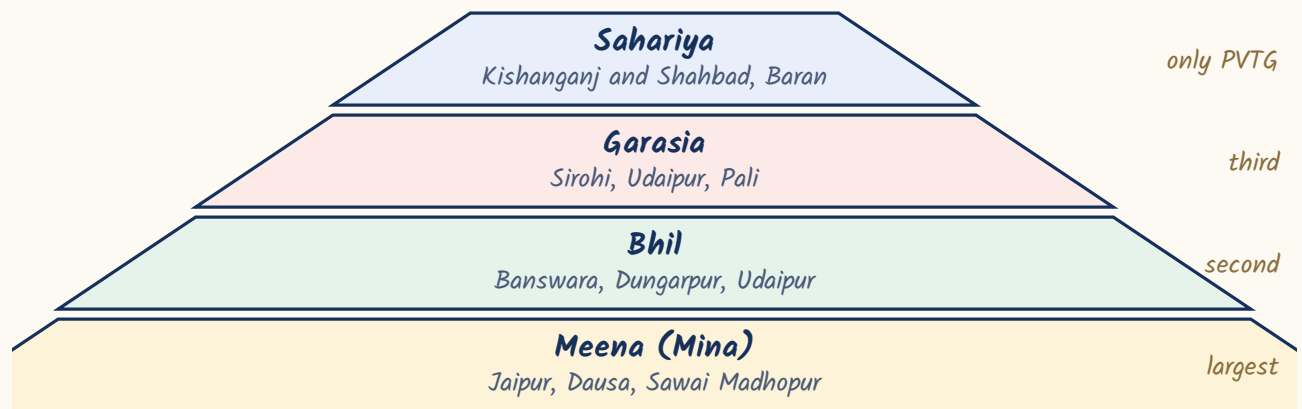
Tribal Rajasthan - where the Scheduled Tribes actually live



The tribes of Rajasthan - the master table

Rajasthan has twelve notified Scheduled Tribes. You need four of them in detail and the rest by one identifying feature each. The order by population is the first thing asked: Meena is the largest, Bhil second, Garasia third, Sahariya the smallest of the significant ones but the most vulnerable.

The tribes of Rajasthan in order of size



The four major tribes - district, feature, keyword

Tribe	Where they live	Distinctive fact
Meena (Mina)	Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli	LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan; settled cultivators
Bhil	Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Second largest; hamlet called 'palli' or 'phala'; Gavri dance-drama
Garasia	Sirohi (Abu Road, Pindwara), Udaipur (Kotra, Jhadol), Pali (Bali)	Third largest; shifting cultivation called 'Walra'
Sahariya	Kishanganj and Shahbad tehsils of Baran (the Dang region)	The ONLY PVTG of Rajasthan; headman called 'Kotwal'

The smaller tribes and nomadic communities - one line each

Community	Where	Identifying fact
Damor	Simalwara and Aspur (Dungarpur), parts of Banswara	Village head called 'Mukhi'; Chadwa Tirth fair

Community	Where	Identifying fact
Kathodi	Kotra, Jhadol and Sarada (Udaipur)	Migrants from Maharashtra; make 'katha' (catechu) from khair wood
Kanjar	Scattered, chiefly Hadoti	Denotified nomadic community
Sansi	Scattered, chiefly Bharatpur-Alwar	Denotified nomadic community
Rabari / Raika	Pali, Jodhpur, Nagaur, Sirohi	Camel and sheep herders - the state's pastoralists
Gadia Lohar	Nomadic, all over the state	Wandering blacksmiths; trace descent to Chittorgarh
Bhil-Mina, Dhanka, Naik, Patelia, Seharla	Southern and eastern districts	All notified Scheduled Tribes of Rajasthan

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - the largest Scheduled Tribe of Rajasthan? Answer: Meena (Mina), with Bhil second. RPSC repeats this because students instinctively answer 'Bhil'.

TRAP

Two hard traps here. One: the largest tribe is the MEENA, not the Bhil. Two: the Sahariya live in BARAN district, not in Dungarpur or Banswara - and they are Rajasthan's only Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group. Three, a bonus: the Toda are a tribe of the Nilgiris in Tamil Nadu, not of Rajasthan; RPSC has slipped it into a list of Rajasthani STs.

Tribal customs and vocabulary - the words that get matched

RPSC does not ask you to describe tribal society. It asks you to match a word to a tribe. So learn the vocabulary as pairs. There are about eight words that carry almost every question in this part of the chapter.

Tribal vocabulary - word to tribe, learn as pairs

Word	Tribe	What it means
Palli / Phala	Bhil	The scattered hamlet the Bhil live in
Chimata	Bhil	Shifting cultivation on a hill SLOPE
Dajiya	Bhil	Shifting cultivation on LEVEL land
Gavri	Bhil	Their famous dance-drama, performed after Rakshabandhan
Walra	Garasia	Their slash-and-burn cultivation
Mor-bandiya, Peharavani, Taanana	Garasia	Three of their forms of marriage
Gol-Gadheda	Garasia	Their fair, where a bride may be won
Kotwal	Sahariya	The village headman
Mukhi	Damor	The village or panchayat head
Chadwa Tirth	Damor	Their fair
Katha	Kathodi	Catechu, extracted from khair wood

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 and again in 2018 - 'Walra' is the shifting cultivation of which tribe? Answer: the Garasia. The Bhil equivalents are Chimata and Dajiya. This pair of terms is one of the most repeated facts in Rajasthan Geography.

- Memory hooks for the two headmen - Sahariya has the Kotwal, Damor has the Mukhi.
- Kotwal sounds like a police title; the Sahariya are the group that needed protection.
- Shifting cultivation - Garasia is Walra; Bhil is Chimata on the slope and Dajiya on flat land.
- Chimata from 'chadhai', the climb - that fixes it to the hill slope.

Bhil vs Meena - the two big tribes, opposite in almost everything

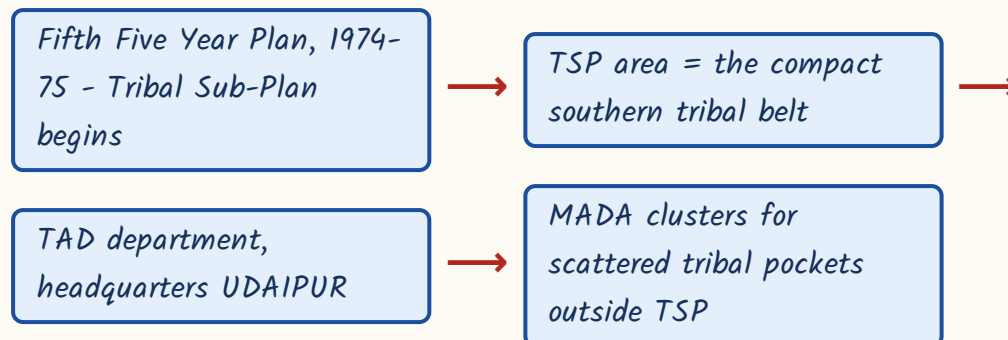
Bhil	Meena (Mina)
Second largest tribe	LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan
Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli
Forest-edge, shifting cultivation (Chimata, Dajiya)	Settled plough agriculture, landholding community
Hamlet settlement called palli/phala	Village settlement, integrated with the plains economy
Gavri dance-drama; strongly distinct culture	Historically ruling and land-owning; heavy presence in state services

One more thing about the Bhil that shows up in the History paper too. Bhil territory is where the Eki movement of Motilal Tejawat took root, and Bhil archers appear throughout Mewar's military history. If the question names Banswara-Dungarpur-Udaipur, the tribe is Bhil, whatever the paper is.

Tribal administration, migration and the last-minute sweep

The delivery machinery for tribal development is a small, clean list and it is asked as a straight one-liner. The Tribal Area Development department has its headquarters at Udaipur - not Jaipur, which is the surprise. The Tribal Sub-Plan approach began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75. And MADA - Modified Area Development Approach - exists for tribal pockets scattered outside the compact TSP area.

How tribal development is organised in Rajasthan



- TAD (Tribal Area Development) department headquarters - Udaipur.
- Tribal Sub-Plan launched in the Fifth Five Year Plan (1974-75).
- MADA covers scattered tribal pockets outside the main TSP block.
- The TSP block is essentially Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh and parts of Udaipur, Sirohi and Chittorgarh.
- Rajasthan's State Population Policy was announced in 2000.
- Rajasthan is a net out-migration state - the streams go to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a four-pair matching question - highest sex ratio Dungarpur (994), highest literacy Kota (76.56%), largest population Jaipur (66.26 lakh), highest child sex ratio Banswara (934). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - the district with the highest decadal growth 2001-11? Answer: Barmer (about 32.5%).

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: tribal development has two new central umbrellas, and both attach neatly to this chapter. PM JANMAN - the Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan - was launched on 15 November 2023, Janjatiya Gaurav Divas, and is aimed specifically at Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups; for Rajasthan that means the Sahariya of Baran, the state's only PVTG. The Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan, approved by the Union Cabinet in September 2024, is the wider village-development mission for tribal-majority villages, and it runs alongside the state's own TSP and MADA machinery under the TAD department at Udaipur. If a question pairs a central tribal scheme with a Rajasthan tribe, the PVTG answer is always Sahariya-Baran.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-minute drill. Say these five aloud: Jaipur is the biggest everything except area. Jaisalmer is the emptiest everything except area, where it is the biggest. Kota is the most literate and most urban. Dungarpur is the best sex ratio and the least urban. Jalore is the least literate. Those five sentences cover most of the district questions this chapter can throw.

REVISION RECAP

1. All Rajasthan population data in the paper = Census 2011. Next census notified for 2027 (as of September 2026).
2. 6,85,48,437 persons = 5.66% of India; 8th in population, 1st in area.
3. Decadal growth 21.31% against India's 17.70%; down from 28.41% in 1991-2001.
4. Density 200 (India 382), up from 165 in 2001. Sex ratio 928 (India 943). Child sex ratio 888 (India 919).
5. Literacy 66.11% - male 79.19%, female 52.12%; a 27-point gender gap, widest among major states.
6. Highest: Jaipur population and density, Kota literacy and urbanisation, Dungarpur sex ratio, Banswara child sex ratio, Barmer growth, Jhunjhunu male literacy.

7. Lowest: Jaisalmer population and density, Jalore literacy, Dholpur sex ratio and area, Jhunjhunu child sex ratio, Dungarpur urbanisation, Sri Ganganagar growth.
8. Top sex ratios in order - Dungarpur 994, Rajsamand 990, Pali 987. Bottom - Dholpur 846.
9. Top populations in order - Jaipur 66.26, Jodhpur 36.87, Alwar 36.74, Nagaur 33.07 lakh.
10. Urban 24.89% vs India 31.16%. Only three million-plus cities: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.
11. Religion 2011: Hindu 88.49, Muslim 9.07, Sikh 1.27, Jain 0.91, Christian 0.14 per cent.
12. SC 17.83% (1.22 crore); ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh).
13. ST share highest Banswara; ST number highest Udaipur; ST share lowest Nagaur. SC share highest Sri Ganganagar; SC number highest Jaipur.
14. Tribe order by size: Meena > Bhil > Garasia; Sahariya is the state's only PVTG, in Baran.
15. Bhil = palli/phala, Chimata and Dajiya, Gavri. Garasia = Walra, Gol-Gadheda, Morbandiya.
16. Sahariya headman = Kotwal; Damor head = Mukhi; Kathodi make katha from khair wood.
17. Rabari/Raika herd camels and sheep; Gadia Lohar are nomadic blacksmiths from Chittorgarh; Kanjar and Sansi are denotified communities.
18. TAD headquarters Udaipur; Tribal Sub-Plan from the Fifth Plan, 1974-75; MADA for scattered pockets.
19. State Population Policy 2000; Rajasthan is a net out-migration state towards Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.
20. Administrative map now: 41 districts in 7 divisions - Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.